

Claude Vibe Coding & Engineering

A Complete Guide

5 chapters compiled into one PDF

Snehal Kadiya

+91 9974031480

snehaliteng@gmail.com

<https://snehaliteng.github.io/>

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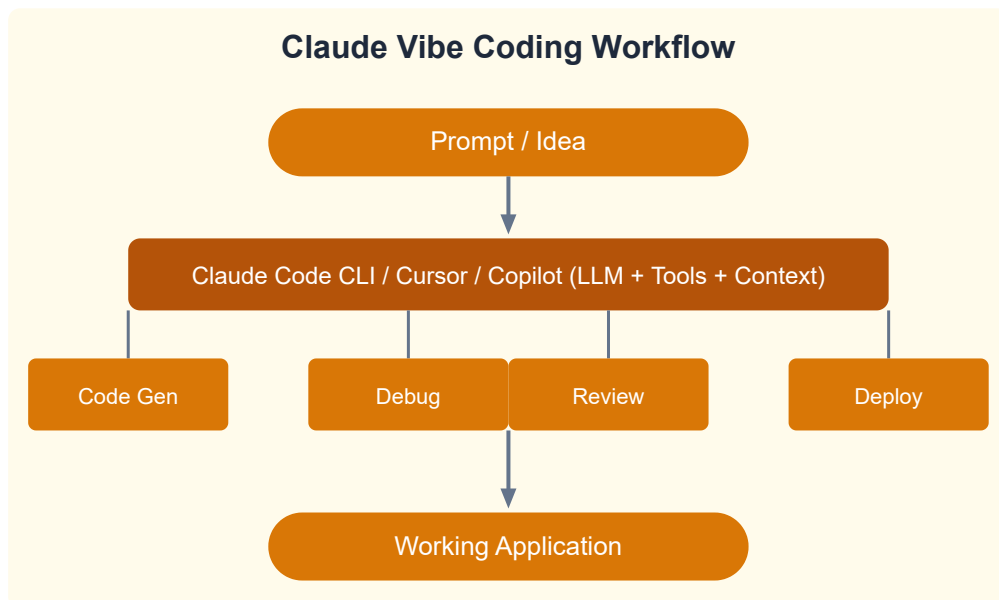
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<https://snehaliteng.github.io/tutorials/claude-vibe-course/>

Vibe Coding for Fun & Profit

Core Concepts

"Vibe coding" is an AI-native coding paradigm where you describe what you want in natural language and let AI generate the code. The shift is from writing code line-by-line to curating AI-generated output.



AI Foundations

Concept	Description
LLMs	Large Language Models power code generation (Claude, GPT-4o)
Tools & Loops	AI reads files, runs commands, iterates on feedback
Context Engineering	Writing effective prompts and files <code>agents.md</code> / <code>claude.md</code>
Workflow Evolution	From manual coding to AI-assisted to fully AI-driven

IDE Hands-On

Compare the major AI coding IDEs:

Tool	Strengths	Best For
Cursor	Deep context awareness, inline editing	Daily development
Copilot	GitHub integration, VS Code native	Enterprise teams
Codex CLI	Terminal-native, agentic actions	Automation scripts
Claude Code	Full project context, checkpoints	Complex codebases

Building a Kanban App

```
# In Cursor or Claude Code CLI, you can prompt:
"Create a full-stack Kanban board with FastAPI backend and vanilla JS frontend.
Include: drag-and-drop, add/delete columns, persist to SQLite."

# The AI will generate:
# backend/main.py - FastAPI routes
# frontend/index.html - Drag-and-drop UI
# backend/models.py - SQLite models
```

Multi-Model Environments

- **YOLO Mode** — Let AI run commands autonomously
- **Responsible Coding** — Always review AI-generated code for security
- **Cross-Model Collaboration** — Switch between Claude, GPT-4o, and local models

Full-Stack Workflows

Build commercial MVPs quickly: FastAPI + Docker + SQLite + a modern frontend.

```
# FastAPI setup
pip install fastapi uvicorn sqlalchemy

# Dockerfile
FROM python:3.11
COPY . /app
RUN pip install -r requirements.txt
CMD ["uvicorn", "main:app", "--host", "0.0.0.0"]
```

 **Exercise:** Use Claude Code CLI or Cursor to build a Kanban board app. Start with "Create a Kanban board with FastAPI backend and HTML/CSS/JS frontend." Iterate by adding drag-and-drop, local persistence, and column management. Use Docker to containerize the final product.

Vibe Engineering as a Professional

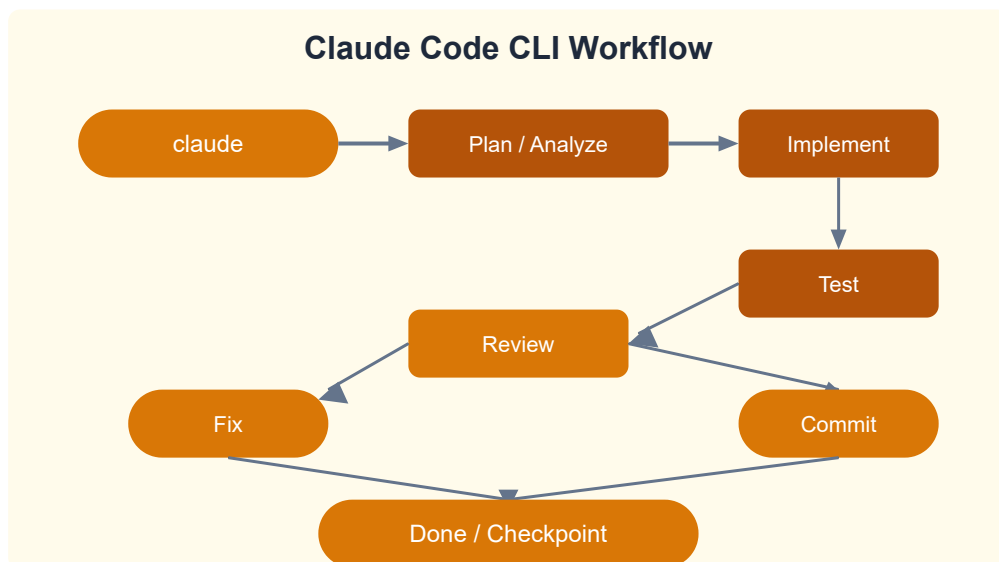
Claude Code CLI

Claude Code is Anthropic's agentic CLI tool. It operates in your terminal with full file system access, git integration, and the ability to run commands.

```
# Installation
npm install -g @anthropic-ai/claude-code

# Start a session
claude

# Or pipe a prompt directly
echo "Explain this codebase" | claude -p
```



Advanced Controls

Command	Description
<code>/plan</code>	Generate a plan before writing code
<code>/review</code>	Review recent changes
<code>/checkpoint</code>	Save a session checkpoint
<code>--yolo</code>	Autonomous mode — run commands without approval

```
# Using checkpoints
claude --checkpoint save "pre-refactor"
# ... make changes ...
claude --checkpoint load "pre-refactor" # Rollback if needed
```

Ecosystem Extensions: MCP Servers

Model Context Protocol (MCP) servers extend Claude's capabilities with custom tools.

```
// MCP server configuration in claude.json
{
  "mcpServers": {
    "jira": {
      "command": "node",
      "args": ["mcp-jira-server.js"],
      "env": { "JIRA_TOKEN": "${JIRA_TOKEN}" }
    },
    "github": {
      "command": "node",
      "args": ["mcp-github-server.js"]
    }
  }
}
```


Professional Integrations

- **Jira** — Create and update tickets from Claude
- **GitHub** — PR review, issue management, code review
- **Custom Skills** — Reusable prompt templates for common tasks

Production SaaS Project

Build a legal document generator SaaS with:

- `claude.md` project context file
- Custom skills for legal document generation
- Jira integration for feature tracking
- FastAPI backend with user authentication
- Automated deployment pipeline

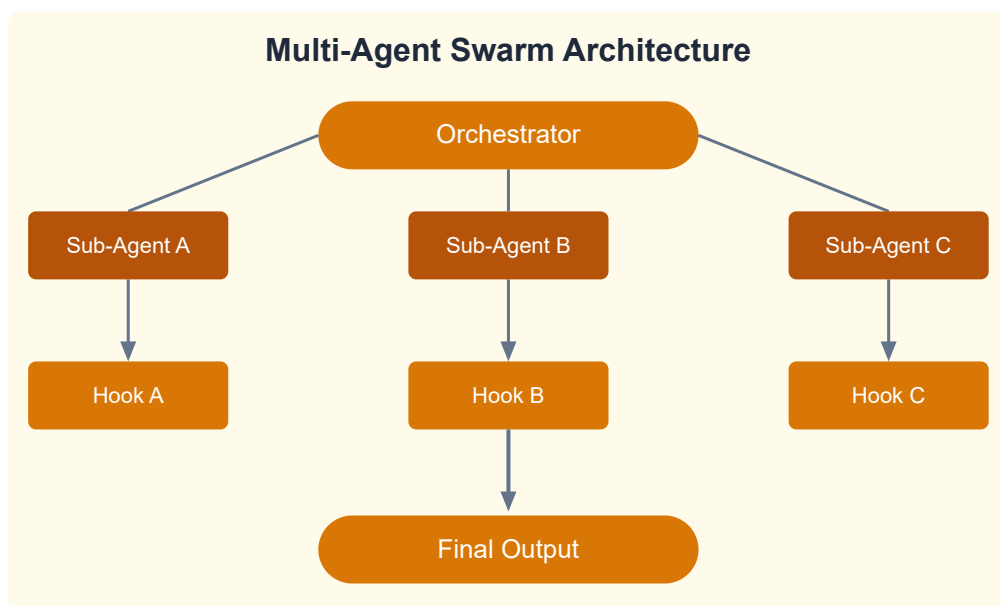
```
# claude.md – Project context file
# Project: LegalDoc Generator
# Stack: FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Jinja2 templates
# Conventions: Black formatting, pytest, async views
# Key files: /app/main.py, /app/models/, /app/templates/
```

 **Exercise:** Set up Claude Code CLI in a project. Configure an MCP server for GitHub (issue management). Create a `claude.md` context file. Build a small SaaS feature end-to-end: create a Jira ticket from Claude, implement the feature, open a PR, and review the PR — all from the CLI.

Vibe Engineering as an Expert

Multi-Agent Architectures

Expert-level vibe engineering uses swarms of sub-agents, each with specialized roles, orchestrated by hooks and custom commands.



Sub-Agents & Hooks

```
// Claude swarm configuration
{
  "agents": {
    "frontend": {
      "role": "Frontend Developer",
      "context": ["/frontend/**", "tailwind.config.js"],
      "hooks": {
        "pre-commit": "lint:check",
        "post-deploy": "e2e:test"
      }
    },
    "backend": {
      "role": "Backend Developer",
      "context": ["/backend/**", "requirements.txt"],
      "hooks": {
        "pre-commit": "pytest",
        "post-merge": "migrate:db"
      }
    }
  }
}
```

Controlled Chaos: Swarms

Swarms are groups of agents that work in parallel on different aspects of a problem. An orchestrator coordinates their outputs.

```
# Swarm orchestrator pattern
class SwarmOrchestrator:
    def __init__(self):
        self.agents = {
            "planner": Agent("plan"),
            "coder": Agent("code"),
            "tester": Agent("test"),
            "reviewer": Agent("review")
        }

    async def run(self, task):
        plan = await self.agents["planner"].run(task)
        code = await self.agents["coder"].run(plan)
        test_report = await self.agents["tester"].run(code)
        review = await self.agents["reviewer"].run(code, test_report)
        return review
```

Cloud Sandboxes

Execute agents remotely in cloud sandboxes (Sprites.dev, Modal) for secure, scalable execution.

```
claude --sandbox sprites # Run in cloud sandbox
```

Scale & SDKs

The Claude Agent SDK enables programmatic agent creation and orchestration for large codebases.

```
pip install claude-agent-sdk

from claude_agent import Agent, Swarm

agent = Agent(
    name="CodeReviewer",
    model="claude-sonnet-4-20250514",
    instructions="Review code for bugs, security, and style."
)

swarm = Swarm(agents=[agent], orchestrator="sequential")
result = swarm.run("Review the PR #42 changes")
```

Advanced Swarms & Capstone

The Gastown orchestration pattern enables parallel agent execution with dynamic task assignment.

Capstone: Trader Workstation

Build a complete trading platform using multi-agent swarms:

- **Data Agent** — Fetches market data from APIs
- **Analysis Agent** — Runs technical analysis
- **Risk Agent** — Assesses portfolio risk
- **Execution Agent** — Places trades via broker API
- **Reporting Agent** — Generates performance reports

 **Exercise:** Build a multi-agent swarm for a trading platform. Configure sub-agents for data, analysis, risk, and execution. Use hooks for pre-trade checks and post-trade logging. Deploy the orchestrator to a cloud sandbox. The final system should be able to: fetch real-time data, analyze trends, assess risk, and execute paper trades autonomously.

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4. Practice & Resources

Quick Reference Guide

Task	Command / Tool
Start Claude Code CLI	<code>claude</code>
Pipe prompt to Claude	<code>echo "prompt" claude -p</code>
Save checkpoint	<code>claude --checkpoint save "name"</code>
Load checkpoint	<code>claude --checkpoint load "name"</code>
YOLO mode	<code>claude --yolo</code>
Plan before coding	<code>/plan</code> command in Claude
Review changes	<code>/review</code> command in Claude
MCP server config	<code>claude.json</code> → <code>mcpServers</code>
Cloud sandbox	<code>claude --sandbox sprites</code>
Project context	<code>claude.md</code> file in project root

Useful Resources

- [Claude Code CLI Documentation](#)
- [MCP Specification](#)
- [Cursor IDE](#)
- [GitHub Copilot](#)
- [Sprites.dev — Cloud sandbox for AI coding](#)

3-Week Study Plan

Week	Topic	Activities
1	Vibe Coding	Setup Cursor/Claude Code, build Kanban app, learn context engineering
2	Vibe Engineering	Claude Code CLI mastery, MCP servers, Jira/GitHub integration, SaaS project
3	Expert Engineering	Multi-agent swarms, hooks, cloud sandboxes, trading platform capstone

IDE / Tool Comparison

Tool	Cost	Best For	AI Models
Cursor	\$20/mo	Daily coding with deep context	Claude, GPT-4o
Copilot	\$10/mo	Enterprise teams, VS Code	GPT-4o, Claude
Claude Code CLI	API usage	Complex projects, agentic workflows	Claude
Codex CLI	API usage	Terminal-native automation	GPT-4o
OpenCode	Open source	Self-hosted, custom workflows	Various

 **Final Capstone:** Build a complete multi-agent SaaS platform using all three levels: (1) vibe-code the initial prototype, (2) engineer it professionally with MCP servers, claude.md context, and CI/CD, (3) add expert-level multi-agent swarm orchestration for critical workflows. Deploy with cloud sandboxes and document the entire process.

5. References

Glossary

Term	Definition
Vibe Coding	AI-native coding where you describe intent and AI generates code
Claude Code CLI	Anthropic's terminal-based agentic coding tool
MCP	Model Context Protocol — standardized tool interface for AI
Context File	<code>claude.md</code> or <code>agents.md</code> — project instructions for AI
Checkpoint	Saved session state for rollback
YOLO Mode	Autonomous mode where AI runs commands without approval
Sub-Agent	Specialized agent within a larger swarm
Hook	Automated action triggered by events (pre-commit, post-deploy)
Swarm	Group of coordinated agents working in parallel
Sandbox	Isolated cloud environment for safe AI code execution

Cheatsheet

```
# Claude Code CLI Cheatsheet

# Install
npm install -g @anthropic-ai/claude-code

# Start session
claude

# Quick prompt
echo "explain this" | claude -p

# Session controls
/plan      # Generate a plan
/review    # Review changes
/summarize # Get session summary
/checkpoint # Save state

# Flags
--yolo      # Autonomous mode
--model MODEL # Use specific Claude model
--resume    # Resume last session
--verbose   # Detailed output

# Config file (claude.json)
{
  "mcpServers": { "serverName": { "command": "node", "args": ["server.js"] } }
}

# Project context (claude.md)
# Place in project root with conventions, stack, and key files.
```

Claude Model Comparison

Model	Best For	Context
Claude Haiku	Fast, lightweight tasks	200K
Claude Sonnet	Balanced speed/quality	200K
Claude Opus	Complex reasoning, code	200K

 **Congratulations!** You've completed the Claude Vibe Coding & Engineering course. You can now vibe-code prototypes, engineer production systems with Claude Code CLI, and orchestrate expert-level multi-agent swarms for complex applications.